Table 11-44. *PHP FILTER_SANITIZE constants*

Sanitize constant	Logic
FILTER_SANITIZE_ENCODED	URL encode a string
FILTER_SANITIZE_SPECIAL_CHARS	Like htmlspecialchars()
FILTER_SANITIZE_FULL_SPECIAL_CHARS	Like htmlentities()
FILTER_SANITIZE_EMAIL	Removes non-Latin characters and digits, plus some meta-characters. Unfit for purpose.
FILTER_SANITIZE_URL	Similar to email sanitisation. Also unfit for purpose in 2025.
FILTER_SANITIZE_NUMBER_INT	Remove non digit characters and +/- symbols
FILTER_SANITIZE_NUMBER_FLOAT	Similar to integer, can be flagged to allow decimals
FILTER_SANITIZE_ADD_SLASHES	Like addslashes()

You might encounter FILTER_SANITIZE_STRING or FILTER_SANITIZE_STRIPPED on your travels, which stripped tags and encoded quote characters. These filters were deprecated in PHP 8.1.0. FILTER_SANITIZE_MAGIC_QUOTES used to be an alias of FILTER_SANITIZE_ADD_SLASHES but was deprecated in PHP 7.1.0.

It probably won't surprise you to find out that this too has oddities and weirdness.

```
var_dump(filter_var('1234abc', FILTER_SANITIZE_NUMBER_INT));
var_dump(filter_var('123.4abc', FILTER_SANITIZE_NUMBER_FLOAT));
```

```
Output:
string(4) "1234"
string(4) "1234"
```

FILTER_SANITIZE_NUMBER_INT is comparatively sane: it will extract the integer portion of a string. FILTER_SANITIZE_NUMBER_FLOAT however, appears to be unaware of decimal numbers, which is a shame given its name. In this case the filter has given us a number that is ten times the value of the one contained in the input string, which is less than useful. Again, we can mitigate with a flag…